IDEATION PHASE

Empathy Map Canvas

Streamlining IT procurement with standard laptop order automation

Session detail	Working value
Date	1 October 2026
Team / facilitator	SWTID-2026-2670
Project	Automating standard laptop orders with Flow Designer
Research status	Complete during workshop; do not treat prompts as findings

Purpose

Use this canvas to capture what one affected person thinks and feels, hears, sees, says and does while requesting or fulfilling a standard laptop order. Record pains and desired gains separately. Create a separate map for each role so different viewpoints do not get blended together.

Choose one person or role for this map

Persona to map	Select or describe
Employee requesting a laptop	[New starter / replacement / refresh / other]
Manager approving or supporting a request	[Team / decision context]
IT service or endpoint coordinator	[Intake / configuration / handoff responsibility]
Procurement or purchasing coordinator	[Review / sourcing / order responsibility]
Other affected role	[Role and relationship to the process]

Set the situation

Context prompt	Notes
What event starts the request?	[For example: new starter, replacement, planned refresh; specify actual scenario]
Which part of the journey are we exploring?	[Request, review, approval, purchase, delivery, asset setup, or handoff]
What evidence will we use?	[Interview, observation, request record, ticket, process document, or other]

Capture evidence carefully

- Write exact quotes or observed actions where possible. Mark interpretations as hypotheses and note who can verify them.

- The prompts on the next page are cues, not answers. Do not assume delays, feelings, workarounds, or policy rules without evidence.

- Flow Designer is the project's solution direction. Keep it out of the persona's voice unless the person actually discusses it.

Empathy map

Map one role in one specific standard laptop ordering situation. Add a source or quote beside important observations.

Persona / role	**Situation / journey stage**	**Evidence source and date**
[Who is this map about?]	[What is happening, and when?]	[Interview / observation / artifact]

THINK AND FEEL	**HEAR**
What matters most to this person in this situation? What worries, expectations, or hopes do they express? **Notes, quotes, or observations**	What do managers, IT, procurement, HR, or colleagues tell them? What policies, guidance, or informal advice shape their view? **Notes, quotes, or observations**
SEE	**SAY AND DO**
What request forms, catalog choices, approvals, status messages, or handoffs do they encounter? What in their work environment affects the process? **Notes, quotes, or observations**	What do they say about the request or process? Capture exact words. What actions or workarounds do you observe, such as checking status or asking for help? **Notes, quotes, or observations**
PAINS	**GAINS**
Where do they experience effort, uncertainty, waiting, repetition, or risk? What blocks progress or creates a poor handoff? Validate each item. **Notes, quotes, or observations**	What outcome would make this experience successful for them? What would help them feel informed and confident? How would success be recognized? **Notes, quotes, or observations**

Synthesis

What did we learn?	Notes
Strongest evidence-backed need or barrier	[Summarize without proposing a feature]
Important contradiction or unknown	[What needs more research?]
Opportunity to explore	[How might we help this person achieve the desired outcome?]

Next step: Validate the themes with the people represented here, then carry the strongest evidence-backed needs into problem definition and solution ideation.